

1. BRAINSTORMING & IDEATION

Project Title

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Introduction

The Brainstorming and Ideation Phase is the initial stage of the project, where the existing IT procurement problem is identified and possible solutions are generated. In this project, the focus is on improving the standard laptop procurement process by reducing manual work, delays, and configuration issues. The idea is to use ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate the creation and assignment of configuration tasks after a standard laptop request is approved. This phase helps define the user need, generate suitable ideas, identify project objectives, and establish the overall direction of the project.

Problem Identification

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, particularly when handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step can be overlooked or delayed. This may cause user frustration, increased waiting time, and inefficient use of IT department resources.

Initial Idea

The initial idea is to automate the standard laptop procurement and configuration workflow using **ServiceNow Flow Designer**. When a standard laptop is requested and the service request is approved, an automated catalog task can be created and assigned to the Hardware group for laptop configuration.

User Need

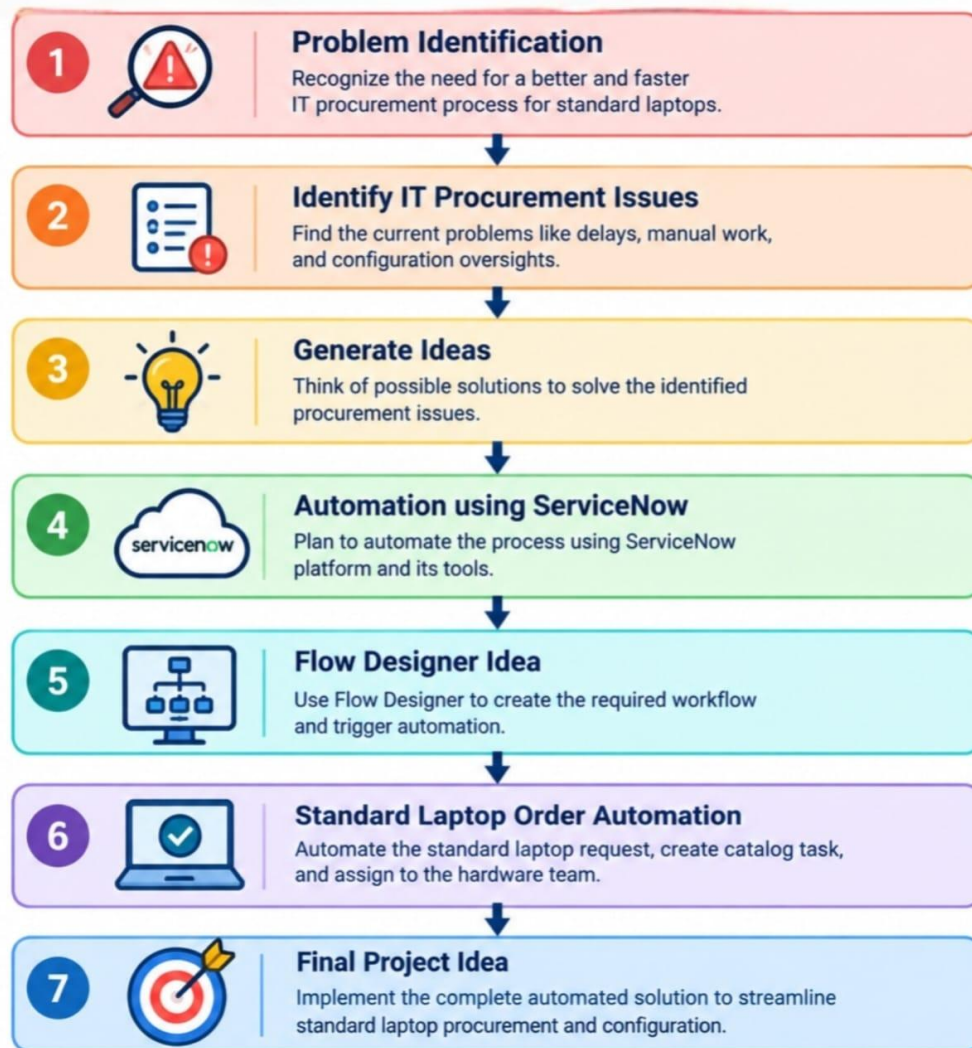
The IT procurement team needs a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team. This helps ensure that laptops are configured promptly after arrival, reducing user waiting time and manual intervention.

Ideas Generated

- Automate the creation of a Catalog Task after approval of a standard laptop request.
- Automatically assign the configuration task to the Hardware group.

- Automatically update the task short description and description with the laptop configuration requirement.
- Use ServiceNow Flow Designer to connect the Service Catalog request with the automated task.
- Reduce manual work and potential errors in the procurement process.
- Improve task allocation and overall efficiency within the IT department.

Brainstorming Process / Project Flow



Project Objectives Identified

- Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
- Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
- Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
- Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

Expected Outcome

The brainstorming and ideation phase identifies an automated workflow in which an approved standard laptop request leads to the creation of a configuration task for the Hardware team. The proposed idea is intended to streamline procurement, minimise manual overhead, reduce user wait times, and support efficient IT resource utilization.

Conclusion

The Brainstorming and Ideation Phase helped to identify the major issues in the standard laptop procurement process and develop an appropriate automation idea. The proposed solution uses ServiceNow Flow Designer to automatically create a catalog task and assign it to the Hardware group after approval. This approach can reduce manual intervention, improve task allocation, minimize delays, and support a more efficient IT procurement process. Thus, the ideas generated in this phase provide a clear foundation for the next phases of the project.